SHOWSYNC · USER GUIDE

Your show files, mirrored in real time.

ShowSync keeps a live, one-way copy of your show folder on a second Mac — so if your main Mac ever fails mid-event, an up-to-date backup is already waiting. This guide covers setup, pairing, syncing, getting files back, and licensing.

Platform macOS 13 or later **Needs** Two Macs, one network **By** Remember Live

WHAT SHOWSYNC DOES

ShowSync runs quietly in the menu bar and mirrors a folder from one Mac (the **Main**) to another (the **Backup**) over your local network. It is built for live production, where a second copy of your cues, sets, recordings, or project files can save a show.

One-way, by design

Syncs only ever travel from Main to Backup. The Backup receives and keeps your files and never overwrites your working copy. The only time files move back to the Main is when you ask for them with Fetch.

Additive and safe

A sync never deletes anything on the Backup. Unchanged files are skipped; changed files are sent again in full. Before a sync, ShowSync checks the Backup has room and that its folder can be written to.

Calm and quiet

It sits in the menu bar using almost no resources, works on events rather than constant polling, and shows honest status at a glance.

Encrypted transfers

Transfers between the two Macs are encrypted with TLS 1.3, and a transfer only ever goes to the Mac you paired with. Trust is key-based, with a pairing step you confirm by hand — no passwords stored.

REQUIREMENTS

- **Two Macs** running **macOS 13 (Ventura) or later** — one acts as Main, one as Backup. Both should run the **same version** of ShowSync.
- Both Macs on the **same local network** (wired is recommended for shows).
- **Local Network access** allowed for ShowSync on both Macs — macOS asks the first time (see First launch & permissions).
- For the Backup's folder, the Mac's internal drive or a **USB 3 or faster** external drive. Network drives and file shares are not supported.
- An **internet connection at first run** to start a trial or activate a license. After activation, ShowSync verifies your license *offline* — no internet needed at show time.

> **GOOD TO KNOW**
>
> A single license covers **two machines**. The Backup edition (receive-only) is always free, so you only need a license on the Mac that sends. Backing up to a Windows PC isn't available yet — it appears in Settings as *"Coming soon"*.

FIRST LAUNCH & PERMISSIONS

The first time ShowSync runs, macOS asks whether it may use your local network — ShowSync explains: *"ShowSync uses your local network to find your Backup Mac and copy show files to it."* Click `Allow` on **both** Macs. Without it, the two Macs can't find or reach each other.

macOS may also ask for access when you choose a folder on the Desktop, in Documents or Downloads, or on an external drive. Allow it, so ShowSync can use the folder you picked.

If Local Network access is blocked, ShowSync says so in the popover: *"If the Backup is on and on this network, macOS may be blocking local network access for ShowSync."* Click `Open Privacy Settings` and turn ShowSync on under Local Network. *"If it's already allowed, switch it off and on again, then quit and reopen ShowSync."*

> **AFTER INSTALLING AN UPDATE**
> After installing a new version without restarting the Mac, the first `Fetch` can fail once. Press it again — it normally works the second time. If it keeps failing, switch ShowSync's Local Network access off and on in Privacy & Security, then quit and reopen ShowSync.

> **ONE COPY PER MAC**
> Only one copy of ShowSync runs on a Mac. Opening it again while it's running — from Finder, Spotlight or the Dock — just opens the running copy's popover.

QUICK START

If you just want to get running, this is the short path. Each step is expanded later in the guide.

1. **Install ShowSync on both Macs.** It appears in the menu bar — click the icon to open it. Click `Allow` when macOS asks about your local network.
2. **On the Backup Mac, set its role to Backup** (Settings → Connection → Role → `Switch to Backup`).
3. **On the Main Mac, start a trial or activate a license** (Settings → License). Until then, the Main Mac runs in free Backup-only mode.
4. **Pair the two Macs.** On the Main Mac, select the Backup in the list under Settings → Connection, then click `Pair Automatically` (Settings → Identity & Trust). Confirm the matching code on the Backup.
5. **Choose your source folder** on the Main Mac (`Choose…`).
6. **Click `Sync Now`.** Your files mirror to `~/Sync` on the Backup.

UPGRADING FROM VERSION 1

If you used ShowSync version 1, install the new version on **both** Macs. Here's what to expect:

- **Your settings and license carry over** — source folder, Backup, Auto Sync and Push Sync, Verify mode, shortcut, Version History and the rest.
- **Pair the two Macs again.** The old pairing isn't used by this version — see Pairing the two Macs.
- **Files already on the Backup are kept.** On the first sync the Backup checks the show files it already holds and only receives what's missing or different. You'll see `Checking files already here…` on the Backup while it reads them — on a large show or a slow drive this can take a while, once.
- **Both Macs should run the same version.** A new Main can't pair with a Backup still on version 1.
- **Going back to version 1 isn't supported** once the new version has saved its settings.

> **TIDY UP**
> Keep only one copy of ShowSync on each Mac — remove any old copy. If you use **Launch at Login**, check it's still on after installing.

MAIN & BACKUP ROLES

Every Mac running ShowSync is either a **Main** or a **Backup**.

ROLE	WHAT IT DOES	MENU-BAR ICON
Main	Sends files — the source machine, the one you work on. This is the licensed role.	Up arrow in a circle
Backup	Receives files into `~/Sync`. Receive-only, and always free.	Down arrow in a circle

To change a Mac's role, open **Settings → Connection → Role** and click `Switch to Backup` or `Switch to Main`. You'll be asked to confirm — *"The app will restart in the new role."*

> **NOTE**
> The `Switch to Main` option only appears when the Mac has an active trial or license. Without one, the Mac stays in free Backup-only mode (see Backup-only mode).

PREPARE THE BACKUP MAC

The Backup Mac receives files. It only needs ShowSync running with its role set to Backup — there's nothing else to turn on in System Settings beyond allowing Local Network access.

1. **Set the role to Backup.** Settings → Connection → Role → `Switch to Backup`. The app restarts as a Backup.
2. **Allow Local Network access** if macOS asks (see First launch & permissions).
3. **Confirm it's ready.** The Backup popover shows **Ready**, **Last received**, the folder files arrive in, and **Storage**. Open Connection Info to see **Network Discovery** and **This Mac's IP**. When files arrive you'll see `Receiving…`.

> **WHERE FILES CAN LAND**
> Incoming files are written to `~/Sync` by default. You can change this to another folder **in your home directory** or on an **external drive** (USB 3 or faster recommended) — but not Documents, Desktop, or Downloads, and not a network drive or share.

PAIRING THE TWO MACS

Pairing establishes a trusted, encrypted connection between Main and Backup. It only has to be done once per pair.

Automatic pairing (recommended)

1. On the Main Mac, open **Settings → Connection**. Leave Discovery on `Automatic`.
2. Your Backup Mac appears in the list of Backups. Select it, then open **Identity & Trust** and click `Pair Automatically`.

3. ShowSync shows `Pairing…`, then a request appears on the **Backup** Mac titled **"Pairing Request"**.

4. On the Backup, check the **verification code** matches the one under *"This Mac's Verification Code"* on the Main, then click `Trust`. If nobody answers, the request closes by itself after about two minutes.

5. The Main shows `Paired with [name]` and the Secure Connection indicator turns to ● **Connected**.

> **ALWAYS CHECK THE CODE**
> The verification code is your security check. Only click `Trust` when the code on the Backup matches the code shown on the Main's Settings screen — that confirms you're pairing with the right machine.

Manual setup

If the Backup doesn't appear in the list, pair by hand with an address and a one-time key:

1. On the Main Mac, open **Settings → Identity & Trust → Pairing** and click `Set Up Manually` (it reads `Set Up Secure Connection` when no Backup has been found).

2. The Main shows a **Set Up Manually** box with an **Address** and a **Key**. Use `Copy Key` and `Copy Address` if you want to paste them somewhere, and keep the Main on the same network. `Done` closes the box — the Main keeps waiting for the Backup.

3. On the Backup Mac, open **Settings → Identity & Trust → Pairing** and click `Set Up Manually`. Type the Address and the Key exactly as shown on the Main, then click `Join`.

4. The Backup confirms *"Secure Connection Established — This Mac is now paired and ready to receive backups."* If it says *"Could Not Connect — Check the address and key and try again."*, click `Retry` and re-type them.

If you use Discovery `Manual`, also enter the Backup's IP on the Main under **Settings → Connection → Destination → Backup IP** (`Edit`, then `Save`). The Backup's IP is shown in its Connection Info.

If you ever need to unpair

In Settings, `Forget This Backup` (on the Main) or `Forget Paired Main` (on the Backup) clears the pairing. You'll be asked to confirm. To re-pair, pair again as above.

CHOOSING FOLDERS

On the Main — the source

Under **Settings → Connection → Source**, click `Choose…` and pick the folder you want mirrored (your show folder, project, recordings, etc.). Until a source is set, ShowSync shows *"Choose a source folder."* If the folder is later moved or renamed, Connection Info marks it **Missing**.

On the Backup — the destination

Files arrive in `~/Sync` by default. To use a different location, open **Settings → Connection → Destination** on the Backup and click `Change`.

> **WHERE THE BACKUP CAN SAVE**
>
> macOS protects **Documents, Desktop, and Downloads**, so the Backup can't write there. Choose a folder **inside your home directory** (the default `~/Sync` works out of the box) or on an **external drive**. If you pick a protected folder, ShowSync tells you: *"This Folder Can't Receive Files Over the Network — Documents, Desktop, and Downloads are protected by macOS. Please choose another folder, like a folder in your home directory. External drives work too, but need one extra macOS setting — you'll see instructions when you select one."*

Keeping room on the Backup

Minimum Free Space (Settings → Connection on the Backup, default **2 GB**, adjustable from 1 to 99 GB): *"Sync is refused if the drive has less than this free."* Before each sync ShowSync also checks the Backup has room for the files about to arrive, and refuses up front — with a message saying how much space to free — rather than failing part-way.

If the Backup's drive goes missing

The switch *"If my backup drive is unavailable, back up to my home folder instead"* is **off** by default. Off, a sync stops with a clear warning when the folder can't be written. On, files go to your home `~/Sync` folder while the drive is away and back to the drive the moment it returns; the Backup popover shows *"Backup drive unavailable — backing up to your home Sync folder"* while that's happening.

Save disk space

Save disk space is **on** by default: *"Keeps the Backup close to the size of the show: changed files are sent whole and the hidden block store is emptied after each sync."* Leave it on unless you have a reason not to.

CHOOSING THE NETWORK

ShowSync can be locked to one network connection. Open **Settings → Connection → Network Interface** on each Mac: *"Locks ShowSync to one network connection: discovery, pairing, and backups all use only this interface. Automatic picks the first available."*

- `Automatic (first available)` — the default. The menu shows which adapter it picked, for example *Automatic – Ethernet*.
- **A named adapter** — Ethernet, Wi-Fi, Thunderbolt Bridge and so on, using macOS's own names. A Thunderbolt cable is treated like any other adapter.

> **SAME NETWORK ON BOTH MACS**
> *"Choose the same network on the Main and the Backup."* Once you pick an adapter, ShowSync uses only that one — it doesn't switch to another link if it goes down. If the picked adapter goes missing you'll see *"Selected network not found — reconnect it or switch to Automatic"*.

SYNCING FILES

Open the Main Mac's popover and click `Sync Now`. ShowSync copies any new or changed files to the Backup. The first sync sends everything; after that, unchanged files are skipped and only new or changed files are sent — a changed file is sent again in full.

The status first reads `Checking for changes…`, then shows progress like `Syncing… 64% · 2.1 GB of 3.3 GB`. You can stop it with `Cancel Sync`. When it finishes you'll see `✓ Synced`, and **Last sync** updates with the time, the number of files sent, and the size. "Synced" means the files are written to the Backup's drive, not just received.

As files arrive, the Backup checks each piece against its fingerprint, and checks again before it resumes an interrupted transfer. To confirm the whole Backup afterwards, use Verify.

A sync never deletes anything on the Backup. If a sync can't run — not enough space, the Backup's folder can't be written, or the show folder is too big for one sync — ShowSync refuses before sending anything and says why.

> **CHECK BEFORE YOU SEND**
>
> Turn on **Check files before sync** (Settings → Behaviour → Options). The Sync button then reads `Check Files` — a preview that copies nothing. It reports *"Check Files Complete"* with a total size and a file count — *"‹size› will be transferred. ‹N› files in your source folder."* — or *"Everything is up to date. No files need to be transferred."* (*"Check Files Failed"* if it couldn't reach the Backup). It doesn't list individual files. While the option is on, `Check Files` and the `^` `⌥` `⌘` `S` shortcut only preview; turn it off to copy by hand. Auto Sync and Push Sync still copy.

RETRY & RESUME

Show networks get bumped. If a sync is interrupted — a cable pulled for a moment, a brief network drop — ShowSync handles it for you. There's no setting; it's always on.

Automatic retry

ShowSync waits for the Backup to answer and tries again — up to **2 automatic attempts**, within 3 minutes of the interruption. While it does, the status reads `Sync interrupted. Retrying (1 of 2)…`. `Cancel Sync` stops it at once.

Resume

An interrupted transfer carries on from where it stopped: the Backup keeps what it already received, and only what's still missing is sent. Anything kept from the interrupted transfer is checked again before it's used.

If it still can't finish

Once the attempts are used up, the sync shows **Failed** with the reason — for example *"Sync interrupted — files may be incomplete"* or *"Couldn't reach the Backup — nothing was sent."* Fix the connection and click `Sync Now`; it picks up where it left off.

> **AUTO SYNC & PUSH SYNC AFTER A FAILURE**
> After a failed sync, Auto Sync and Push Sync carry on at their normal interval. After a *refused* sync (for example not enough space on the Backup), they wait until you've fixed the problem and a sync succeeds.

AUTO SYNC & PUSH SYNC

Two options in **Settings → Behaviour** keep the Backup current without you clicking each time:

Auto Sync

Mirrors on a schedule. Pick from preset intervals — **30 seconds, 5, 10, 15, or 30 minutes, or 1 hour** — or set a **custom interval** of 1–360 minutes and click `Apply`. A `· Auto` badge appears in the popover when it's on, and **Next auto sync** counts down. If the Mac slept through a scheduled sync, it runs once shortly after it wakes.

Push Sync

Mirrors automatically whenever files in the source folder change. ShowSync watches the folder and, once changes settle (go quiet), runs a sync — so it doesn't fire mid-copy. You choose how long to wait for things to settle: a **debounce** of **5, 10, or 30 seconds, or 1 minute**, or a **custom delay** of 5–300 seconds. **Next push sync** shows the countdown. Ideal during an active show when files are being added continuously.

> **TIP**
> You can also trigger a sync from anywhere with the global shortcut `^` `⌥` `⌘` `S` (toggle it under Settings → Behaviour → Options).

VERSION HISTORY

When enabled (Settings → Behaviour), ShowSync keeps previous copies of files on the Backup, so an overwrite never loses the older version.

Before each sync, ShowSync works out which files are about to be replaced and saves the existing Backup copy alongside the new one, with a timestamped name like `report~sync-v~2026-06-16_14-30-05.pdf`. The new version then takes the original's place, and the older copy stays in the same folder as a dated twin.

You choose how many versions to keep per file — **3, 5, 10, 15, or 20** (default 3). Once the limit is reached, ShowSync removes the oldest copies after each sync. There's no time limit — only the count matters.

What it covers

Version History applies to files that are **changed or overwritten**. Because ShowSync is additive — it never deletes files on the Backup to match the Main — files you delete on the Main are **not** removed or versioned on the Backup; they simply remain. This keeps your Backup safe: a deletion on the Main can never wipe files from the mirror.

> **NOTE**
> Versioning runs within each sync and never delays or blocks a backup.

VERIFYING A BACKUP

To confirm the Backup matches, click `Verify` on the Main. While it runs you'll see `Verifying… (checks every file)` and a `Cancel Verify` button. It reports one of:

● Verified — names & sizes match	Fast verify: every file is on the Backup with the right name and size.
● Verified — all files match	Deep verify: every file's contents match.
● N files differ — re-sync recommended	Some files are missing or different on the Backup. The next sync brings them up to date.
● N files couldn't be checked	Files were in use or unreadable — not a mismatch. Verify again in a moment.
● Verify failed — couldn't reach Backup	Check the connection and network.

Fast vs Deep verify

You can choose how thorough Verify is, under **Settings → Behaviour → Verify**:

Fast (default)

"Checks file names and sizes only. Quick for large files." Ideal for a quick "is everything there and the right size?" check, especially with large media.

Deep

"Checks every file's contents (checksum). Most thorough." It catches a file that's the right size but has changed or become damaged. Every byte is read on both Macs, so it takes longer on a large show. If it finds a difference, the next sync sends that file again.

> **WHICH SHOULD I USE?**
> Use **Fast** for a quick check that everything is there. Switch to **Deep** before a critical show, when you want the contents confirmed. The result wording tells you which check ran, so you always know what was confirmed.

Verifying from the Backup

The Backup has its own `Verify Backup` button. It shows two lines:

- **This Mac's copy:** — a check of the data the Backup keeps: *"Intact — all stored data re-checked, no corruption found"*, *"Nothing stored to check yet"* (normal with Save disk space on), or *"Backup copy is damaged — re-sync recommended"*.
- **Compared with the Main:** — the Main's comparison of the source folder against the Backup, in the same words the Main uses. If the Main isn't connected it says *"The Main isn't connected"*.

> **LIMITS**
> Verify checks up to 100,000 files at a time. For a bigger folder it says *"Backup has too many files to check in one pass — sync, then verify again."*

FETCH FROM BACKUP

Need a file back from the Backup during a show? Fetch brings the files you choose from the Backup to the Main — no role switch, no re-pairing.

1. On the Main, click `Fetch` (next to Sync Now and Verify). The **Fetch from Backup** screen lists the Backup's files.

2. Tick the files or folders you want — ticking a folder takes everything in it. Use `Search files…` to find something, and `Refresh` to list the Backup's files again.

3. Check **Fetch to**. Files go to a `From Backup` folder beside your source folder by default; click `Choose…` to pick another. It can never be inside the source folder, so fetched files are never synced back.

4. Click `Fetch N files`. Progress shows as it runs, and `Cancel Fetch` stops it. When it's done: `✓ Fetched N files · size`.

> **WHILE A FETCH RUNS**
> Sync Now, Verify and Test Speed wait — they say *"A Fetch is in progress. Try again when it has finished."* An Auto Sync that comes due is skipped until its next interval. If this Mac hasn't enough room, Fetch says *"Not enough space on this Mac for this Fetch. Free up space or choose a smaller selection."* The Backup's History records each Fetch.

DELETE FROM BACKUP

Delete from Backup removes files from the Backup Mac — an old show, a wrong upload — without walking over to it. A sync never deletes anything; this is the only way files are removed from the Backup, and only the files you choose.

1. On the Main, click the **trash icon** at the bottom of the popover. The **Delete from Backup** screen says *"Deletes on the Backup only. Nothing on this Mac is touched."*

2. Tick the files or folders to remove (`Search files…` and `Refresh` work as in Fetch), then click `Delete N files…`.

3. Confirm *"Delete N files (size) from [Backup]?"* by typing `DELETE` — *"Type DELETE to remove these items from the Backup. This can't be undone."* — and clicking `Delete`.

4. The result reads `✓ Deleted N files · size from the Backup`.

> **PERMANENT**
> Deleted files are gone from the Backup — they don't go to a Trash. Files that are still in your source folder on the Main are marked *"still on this Mac — comes back on the next sync"*: the next sync copies them to the Backup again. Delete from Backup isn't available while a sync, verify, speed test or fetch is running.

HISTORY

Click the **clock icon** at the bottom of the popover to open History. It starts empty — *"No sync history yet"*.

Each row on the Main shows the time (and the date if it wasn't today), a tag — `Manual`, `Auto` or `Push` — then `N files · X sent`, how long it took, and `via ‹adapter›`. The file count is the files that actually had data sent, not the folder total. The icon shows the outcome:

● Tick	Finished.
● Warning triangle	Finished, but to the home-folder fallback — marked *(fallback)*.
● Cross / No-entry	Failed, or refused before anything was sent.
Stop	Cancelled.

The Backup has its own History, tagged `Receive`, `Delete` and `Fetch` — for example *"Received N files · size from [Main]"*, *"N files deleted by [Main]"*, *"N files fetched by [Main]"*. A sync that brought nothing new adds no row there.

READING THE STATUS

The menu-bar icon is an up arrow in a circle on the Main and a down arrow on the Backup. Its colour tells you the state at a glance:

○ Plain	Idle and ready, not set up yet, or cancelled — black or white to match your menu bar.
● Yellow	Syncing (Main) or receiving (Backup).

● Green	Finished successfully.
● Orange	Warning — the drive is unavailable so files are going to the home folder, or the chosen network adapter is missing.
● Red	Error — a sync failed or was refused, the network was lost, or the Backup is below its minimum free space. See the popover for detail.

Green, orange and red stay until you open the popover; then the icon goes back to plain. ShowSync doesn't send macOS notifications — the icon and the popover are where status shows.

In the popover

The Main's header reads **Ready** (green when it's ready to sync, grey while setup is incomplete), **Checking for changes...**, **Syncing**, **Synced**, **Failed** or **Cancelled** — or, when something's wrong, **Not connected**, **Backup app not running**, **Selected network not found** or **Not discoverable**. The Backup's header reads **Ready**, **Receiving**, **Not discoverable** or **Main not connected**. If Sync Now can't run, the reason appears under the buttons (see Troubleshooting).

CONNECTION INFO

Both popovers have a **Connection Info** fold-out — click it to open or close it; ShowSync remembers which you chose.

On the Main

- **Backup Network Discovery** — the Backup's name (Automatic discovery).
- **Backup IP** — marked *(auto)* when it was found automatically.
- **Connection status** — ● Connected, ● Not Connected or Checking..., or *Backup app not running* / *Selected network not found*.
- **Source Folder** — marked *Missing* if it can't be found.
- **Backup Folder** — with its free space, or *(drive unavailable)* / *Backup not reachable*.
- **This Mac's IP** — with the adapter in use.
- **Main version** and **Backup version** — with · *Match* or · *Different*.

On the Backup

- **Network Discovery** and **This Mac's IP**.
- A **Main** block — the paired Main's name, whether it's connected, and *Last seen* with the time.

- **Main version** and **Backup version**, as on the Main.

> GOOD TO KNOW
> If the two versions differ and the Backup's copy is too old for something the Main can do, the Main says *"The Backup's ShowSync is too old for … — update it"*. Free space reads a few percent lower than Finder shows.

TRIAL & LICENSE

The full Main (sending) capability is unlocked by a 14-day free trial or a purchased license. Open **Settings → License**.

Starting a free trial

Click `Start free trial` to begin a 14-day trial on this Mac, or paste a key you've been given into `Enter license key` and click `Activate`. After activating, you'll see *"Activated — relaunch to enable Main mode."* — quit and reopen ShowSync to switch into Main.

What the status line means

No license	"No license — start a trial or enter a key." The Mac runs in free Backup-only mode.
Trial	"Trial — N days remaining." Full Main capability is unlocked.
Licensed	A purchased license is active. Full capability, no expiry.
Trial expired	The trial has ended; the Mac returns to free Backup-only mode until a license is activated.

Two machines per license

One license activates ShowSync on up to **two Macs**. If you try to activate a third, you'll see *"Already active on the maximum 2 Macs."*

> **OFFLINE AT SHOW TIME**
> Activation needs the internet once. After that, ShowSync verifies your license offline — so it keeps working on isolated show networks with no internet access.

BACKUP-ONLY MODE

When a Mac has no active trial or license, ShowSync runs in **Backup-only mode**: it can still receive files (so a free machine is always useful as a Backup), but the Main sending features are hidden. You'll see the note *"Backup-only — activate a license to enable Main mode."*

Start a trial or activate a license, relaunch, and the full Main capability returns. Your saved role and settings are never lost while in Backup-only mode.

SETTINGS REFERENCE

Settings are opened from the gear icon in the popover. The Main has six groups; the Backup has five.

On the Main

SECTION	WHAT'S INSIDE
Connection	Role (Main/Backup), Discovery (Automatic/Manual), Network Interface, Source folder, Destination (the list of Backups; in Manual, the Backup IP). A Windows Backup option is shown as *"Coming soon"*.
Speed Tests	Adapter Speed (`Test Speed`) and Disk Speed (`Test Disks`) — see Speed Tests.
Identity & Trust	This Mac's name, Backup name, Secure Connection status and verification code, Pairing (Pair Automatically, Set Up Manually, Forget This Backup).
Behaviour	Auto Sync & interval, Push Sync, Version History, Verify mode (Fast / Deep), Check files before sync, Launch at Login, global shortcut, where ShowSync appears (Menu Bar / Menu Bar & Dock).
License	Trial & activation, license status, days remaining.

SECTION	WHAT'S INSIDE
About	Version, credits, and Check for Updates.

On the Backup

SECTION	WHAT'S INSIDE
Connection	Role, Discovery, Network Interface, Destination (`Change`), **Minimum Free Space** (default 2 GB, 1–99 GB — *"Sync is refused if the drive has less than this free"*), *"If my backup drive is unavailable, back up to my home folder instead"* (off by default), and **Save disk space** (on by default).
Identity & Trust	Network Discovery Name, Pairing (Set Up Manually, Forget Paired Main).
Behaviour	Launch at Login, where ShowSync appears (Menu Bar / Menu Bar & Dock).
License	Trial & activation, license status, days remaining.
About	Version, credits, and Check for Updates.

Reset to Defaults (with a confirmation) erases settings, the pairing and sync history and returns ShowSync to its first-launch state. It does not delete your synced files, and it can't be used while a sync is running.

SPEED TESTS

On the Main, **Settings → Speed Tests** has two quick checks to run before a show — run them when nothing else is running.

Adapter Speed — Test Speed

Click `Test Speed`. It *"Measures the selected adapter to the Backup over the real backup path — plug in an adapter and compare before a show."* The result reads like `300 MB/s · ≈34 sec for 10 GB · via Thunderbolt Bridge`. It stays on screen until you test again or pick a different adapter. If the link is very slow you'll see *"Link too slow — under 5 MB/s"*.

Disk Speed — Test Disks

Click `Test Disks`. It *"Measures the Backup's drive and this Mac's source drive with the cache bypassed."* You'll see *Testing the Backup's disk…* then *Testing this Mac's disk…*, and a result for each. With a Test Speed result on screen it names the weakest link: *"Slowest part: … A sync cannot go faster than this."* Without one it says *"Run Test Speed too to see the slowest part."*

> **GOOD TO KNOW**
> Test Disks uses a temporary file that's always removed afterwards, and it stops if a sync, verify, fetch or delete starts. Each drive is measured for at most about 20 seconds, so a drive that slows down only after minutes of writing can look faster than it will be in a long sync. Test Disks isn't available for a Windows Backup.

STAYING AWAKE

While a sync, Fetch, Verify or Delete from Backup runs on the Main — and while the Backup is receiving — ShowSync stops the Mac from going to sleep on its own, so a long transfer isn't cut off by idle sleep. It lets go as soon as the transfer ends. There's no setting and nothing on screen.

> **WHAT IT DOESN'T DO**
> It doesn't stop the **display** from sleeping, a **closed laptop lid** still puts the Mac to sleep, and it doesn't keep the Mac awake while ShowSync is idle between transfers.

UPDATES

Under **Settings → About**, click `Check for Updates`. ShowSync checks for a newer version and reports one of:

● You're up to date	You have the latest version.
● Version X available	A newer version exists — click Download to get it.
● Couldn't check	ShowSync couldn't reach the update service — try again later.

ShowSync doesn't check or install updates on its own — this button is how you check, and `Download` opens the download link in your browser. Update both Macs so they run the same version.

NETWORK & SECURITY

For best performance and security, run ShowSync on a **dedicated, hardwired network**. All transfers between the two Macs are encrypted with **TLS 1.3**, and a transfer only ever goes to the Mac you paired with. Trust is key-based, with a human-confirmed pairing step — no passwords are stored.

ShowSync uses **ShowNetwork**, Remember Live's interface-binding technology, to keep show traffic on the network interface you choose — so your sync stays on your dedicated show network. Pick the interface under **Settings → Connection → Network Interface** (see Choosing the network).

ShowSync pairs one Main with one Backup, Mac to Mac, on your local network. There's no cloud service in between.

Why wired

A dedicated cabled network gives you the fastest, most reliable transfers — often close to full gigabit speed — and keeps show traffic isolated from other devices.

Your working copy stays yours

The Backup receives and keeps your files and never overwrites your working copy on the Main. The only time files move back to the Main is when you ask for them with Fetch.

TROUBLESHOOTING

The Backup doesn't appear when pairing

Confirm both Macs are on the same network, ShowSync is running on both, and both use the same Network Interface. Check that Local Network access is allowed for ShowSync on both Macs — the Main may say *"Still looking — if nothing appears, allow Local Network access for ShowSync in Privacy & Security."* If it still doesn't show, pair by hand with `Set Up Manually` (see Pairing the two Macs).

"macOS may be blocking local network access for ShowSync"

Click `Open Privacy Settings` and turn ShowSync on under Local Network. If it's already on, switch it off and on again, then quit and reopen ShowSync. During manual setup on the Backup the same advice appears as *"Couldn't Reach the Main"*.

"Backup not reachable on selected network"

The Backup can't be reached on the chosen network interface. Check cabling/Wi-Fi, and confirm the Network Interface in Settings → Connection matches the network the Backup is on.

"Selected network not found"

The adapter you picked isn't connected. Reconnect it (plug the cable back in), or switch Network Interface to Automatic.

"Backup app not running"

The Main can't see ShowSync on the Backup Mac. Open ShowSync on the Backup and check it's in the Backup role.

Sync won't start

ShowSync tells you why inline — common reasons: *"Choose a source folder,"* *"No Backup selected,"* *"No Backup user set,"* (Automatic discovery only) *"Connection not yet set up,"* or *"Backup not reachable on selected network."* Resolve the stated item and try again.

A sync was refused for space

The message says how much space the sync needs and how much to free on the Backup. The Backup also shows *"Not enough space on the backup drive. Free up space to resume backups."* when it's below its Minimum Free Space. Free up space on the Backup's drive, then sync again.

"Show folder too big for one sync"

The source folder has more in it than one sync can carry. Move recordings that are already on the Backup out of the source folder (they stay on the Backup), then sync again. If the message says the Backup's version is the limit, update ShowSync on the Backup.

"Sync interrupted — files may be incomplete"

The connection dropped and the automatic retries couldn't finish the sync (see Retry & resume). Check the connection and click `Sync Now` — it picks up where it left off.

The first Fetch after an update fails

Press `Fetch` again — it normally works the second time. If it keeps failing, switch ShowSync's Local Network access off and on in Privacy & Security on the Backup Mac, then quit and reopen ShowSync.

"Already active on the maximum 2 Macs"

Your license already covers two machines. To move it to a different Mac, deactivate it on one of the current machines first, or contact Remember Live.

"This Mac has already used its free trial."

Each Mac gets one free trial. Enter a license key to keep using Main mode.

"That key is for another Remember Live app."

The key belongs to a different Remember Live product. Check you're entering your ShowSync key.

"Couldn't reach the licensing server"

Activation needs internet once. Connect to the internet to activate or start a trial; afterwards ShowSync works offline.

"This Folder Can't Receive Files Over the Network"

You chose a destination macOS protects (Documents, Desktop, or Downloads). Pick a folder **inside your home directory** (such as the default `~/Sync`) or on an **external drive** instead — external drives need one extra macOS setting, and ShowSync shows you how when you select one.

The Main Mac only shows Backup features

It's in Backup-only mode — start a trial or activate a license in Settings → License, then relaunch.

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